Aatman Vaidya

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Research Interests: Human-AI Interaction, Social Computing, Online Safety, AI Safety, Language Models & their Societal Impact

Education

Eberhard Karls University of Tübingen, *Tübingen, Germany* Oct 2025 – Aug 2027 (expected)
Master of Arts in Computational Linguistics

Ahmedabad University, *India* Aug 2019 – Jul 2023
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science & Engineering

Experience

Max Planck Institute for Software Systems (MPI-SWS), *Kaiserslautern, Germany* [🌐] Nov 2026 – Present
Research Assistant
› I am working with **Abhisek Dash** to understand advertisements on TikTok in EU. I am a part of the AI, Computing and Society initiative at MPI-SWS and also affiliated with **SOUNDS** lab at Saarland University.

Aalto University, *Helsinki, Finland* [🌐] Aug 2026 – Oct 2026
Research Assistant
› I am working with **Juhi Kulshrestha** in the Computational Social Science group, to analyse **315K+ ChatGPT** conversations from the UK, Germany, and Spain. Examining how people actually use AI across work, productivity, health, and other domains. Investigating the **economic**, **societal**, and **safety** implications of large-scale AI adoption.

Tattle Civic Tech, *India* [🌐] Aug 2023 – Sep 2025
Research Engineer
› I conducted research on **AI safety** and **online harms**, developing tools and datasets to understand online abuse [🐙]. Co-created a dataset on gender-based violence and developed AI safety benchmark for hate and sex-related harms in India. Evaluated the safety and performance of AI systems across Indian languages.

Selected Publications

S=In Submission, C=Conference, W=Workshop, P=Preprint, J=Journal (Full List of Publications: **Google Scholar**)

S.2 **Auditing Gambling Ads on Meta in the EU and the UK**
Aatman Vaidya, Kiran Garimella
In Submission at ACM FAccT 2027

S.1 **Information Seeking Across ChatGPT, Google Search and YouTube**
Aatman Vaidya, Kiran Garimella
In Submission at CHI 2027

C.4 **Quantifying the Illicit Ecosystem of Betting Apps in India**
Aatman Vaidya, Kiran Garimella
International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media
★ Best Paper Award 🖼 **Runner's Up** (awarded to the second best paper among 140 papers in the conference) **[ICWSM'26]**

W.2 **Transfer Learning for Multilingual Polarization Detection**
Aatman Vaidya
Workshop on Semantic Evaluation at Association for Computational Linguistics **[ACL'26]**

P.2 **Modelling the Spread of Toxicity**
Aatman Vaidya, Harsh Bhagat, Seema Nagar, Amit Nanavati
arXiv:2511.20546 **[ArXiv]**

P.1 **Analysis of Indic Language Capabilities in LLMs**
Aatman Vaidya, Tarunima Prabhakar, Denny George, Swair Shah
arXiv:2501.13912 **[ArXiv]**

W.1 **The Uli Dataset: An Exercise in Experience Led Annotation of oGBV**
Arnav Arora, Maha Jinadoss, Cheshta Arora, Denny George, Brindaalakshmi...Aatman Vaidya, Tarunima Prabhakar
Workshop on Online Abuse and Harms at North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics
★ Outstanding Paper Award 🖼 **[NAACL'24]**

C.3 **Analysing the Spread of Toxicity on Twitter**
Aatman Vaidya, Seema Nagar, Amit Nanavati
ACM International Conference on Data Science and Management of Data **[CODS-COMAD'24]**

Work Mentions and Media Coverage

Pulitzer Center on *"Desi Faces, Foreign Servers: Inside the AI Economy Undressing Women"* — Jun 2026
Digital Futures Lab on *"Advancing Open Source AI in India"* — Feb 2026
Center for Democracy & Technology on *"Moderating Tamil Content on Social Media"* — June 2025
FOSS United on *"Meet The Maintainers, 31 days 31 FOSS Maintainers from India"* — May 2025
World Economic Forum on *"Year of elections: Lessons from India's fight against AI-generated misinformation"* — Aug 2024
NY Times on *"A Small Army Combating a Flood of Deepfakes in India's Election"* — Jun 2024
The Nieman Lab on *"Indian journalists are on the frontline in the fight against election deepfakes"* — May 2024
Digital Public Goods on *"Safeguarding Information Integrity during Elections with Digital Public Goods"* — Apr 2024

Talks

Aalto University on *"Quantifying the Illicit Ecosystem of Betting Apps in India"* — Helsinki, Aug 2026
Max Planck Institute for Software Systems on *"Quantifying the Illicit Ecosystem of Online Betting Apps"* — Kaiserslautern, Jul 2026
Tech4Dev AI Cohort Program on *"Technical Implementation of AI Safety Guardrails"* — Bengaluru, Sep 2025
MisinfoCon India'25 on *"A Look at Open-Source Deepfake Detection"* — Bengaluru, Mar 2025
AI for Global Development by Agency Fund on *"Evaluating lndic Language Performance in LLMs"* — Bengaluru, Mar 2025
DEF India Digital Citizen Summit on *"Tools to respond to Online Gender Based Violence"* — Remote, Apr 2024

Featured Academic Projects and Collaborations

Ecosystem of Online Betting Apps — Jun'25 - Present
w/ Kiran Garimella

- Performed quantitative analysis of the betting app ecosystem in India. We analyzed 22K Meta Ads, 2K Instagram Posts and 329K Google Play Store reviews linking online promotion to downstream user financial harm.
- We systematically identify and quantify a range of harmful practices, including the use of misleading advertisements, deceptive celebrity endorsements, and illegal deepfakes designed to feign legitimacy.
- Analyzing the delivery of betting and gambling advertisements on Meta across the EU, UK, and US to examine how exposure varies across users and markets.
- Investigating the prevalence and characteristics of betting and gambling content in US cable television and sports footage.

Modelling Spread of Hate Speech — Aug'22 - Sep'25
w/ Amit Nanavati, Seema Nagar

- Developed a network-based model to simulate the spread of toxicity on social media, treating users as transformers who amplify, attenuate, or replicate toxic content.
- Conducted a temporal and behavioral analysis of Twitter (100K users, 17.2M posts), Koo (215K users, 16.9M posts), and Gab (62K users, 20.1M posts) networks, constructing directed graphs of up to 2.3M edges to study how toxicity evolves across time.
- Proposed and evaluated peace-bot interventions to mitigate online toxicity. We saw up to 11.6% reduction in total network toxicity depending on graph structure and bot placement strategy.

Teaching and Academic Service

Reviewer: ICWSM'27 '26, PLOS One, COLM'25, WOAH ACL'25, ACL Rolling Review'24
Shared Task: Gendered Abuse Detection in Indic Languages@ICON'24

Discrete Mathematics (MAT 101), Ahmedabad University. *Teaching Assistant* — Winter 2022

Center for Learning and Empowerment (NGO), Volunteer Teacher. — Jul 2023 - Apr 2024

- Taught 20+ secondary school kids mathematics for an entire academic year, at a tribal village in Jharkhand, India.

Programming Club, Ahmedabad University. *Content Head and Event Organiser* — July 2020 - May 2022

Reading Club, Ahmedabad University. *Organiser* — Dec 2021 - May 2022

Skills

Languages	Python, JavaScript, Elixir C/C++, Kotlin, GraphQL
Frameworks/Libraries	PyTorch, Tensorflow, Nodejs, OpenCV, networkx, Elasticsearch, Phoenix, transformers
Technologies	MySQL, PostgreSQL, Docker, AWS (S3, EKS, EC2), Kubernetes, CI/CD, Android Studio